

Tenderly

AI-Powered Volunteer Matching for San Francisco

**When someone has the willingness to help,
Tenderly turns uncertainty into a clear next step.**

AI for Social Good — MLH & DigitalOcean Hackathon · July 2026

The Problem

People want to help but hit three kinds of friction:

- 1 They don't know which organization needs *their* particular skills
- 2 Long, undifferentiated opportunity lists feel overwhelming
- 3 Urgency is invisible — volunteers can't tell when a small commitment could matter most

Meanwhile, nonprofits must explain needs repeatedly and compete for attention even as conditions change across the city.

The Gap

50 listings to browse

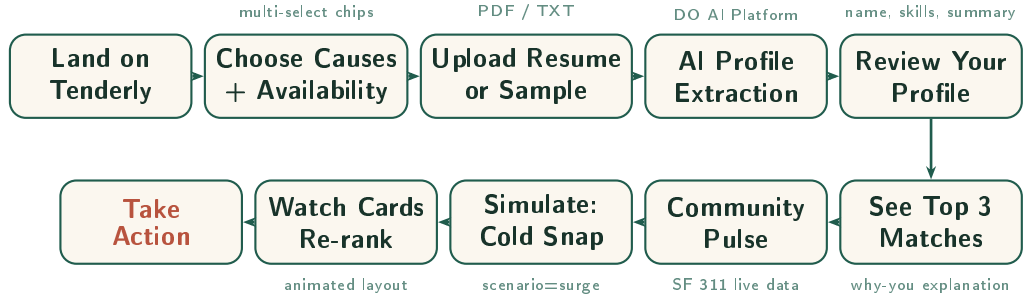


No clear next step



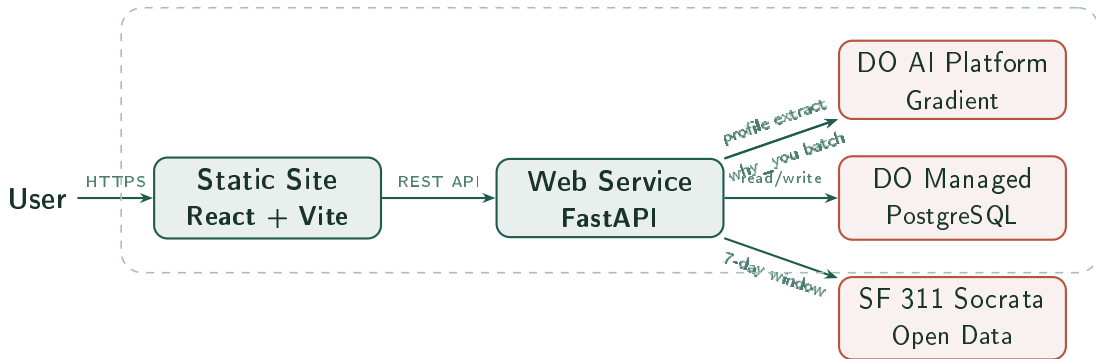
Volunteer gives up

User Journey



DigitalOcean Platform Usage

DigitalOcean App Platform



Static Site

Frontend built from Vite,
serves dist/

Web Service

FastAPI backend on port 8080

AI Platform

2 inference calls per user

journey

How Matching Works

Weighted Match Score

$$\text{score} = \underbrace{0.45}_{\text{skills}} + \underbrace{0.25}_{\text{causes}} + \underbrace{0.20}_{\text{availability}} + \underbrace{0.10}_{\text{location}}$$

Skills — do your abilities match what the org needs?

Causes — do you care about the same issues?

Availability — can you show up when they

What Happens in a Cold Snap?

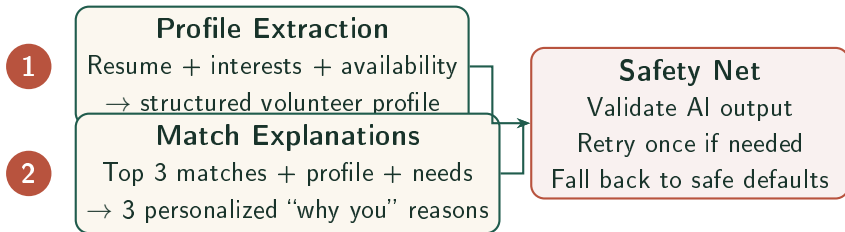
When conditions change in SF:

- Food and shelter roles get a **score boost**
- Neighborhoods with more reported need rise higher
- Urgency labels update (medium → high)

Explainable, Not a Black Box

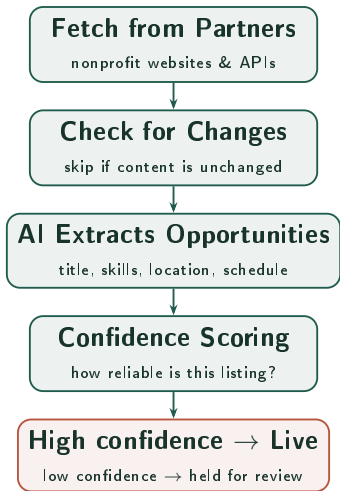
Every recommendation comes with a plain-language reason: “Your project

DigitalOcean AI Platform — Two Calls Per Journey



Key guarantee: If the AI service is down, every response falls back to pre-written defaults. The app keeps working — the volunteer just sees a generic explanation instead of a personalized one.

How Opportunities Get Into Tenderly



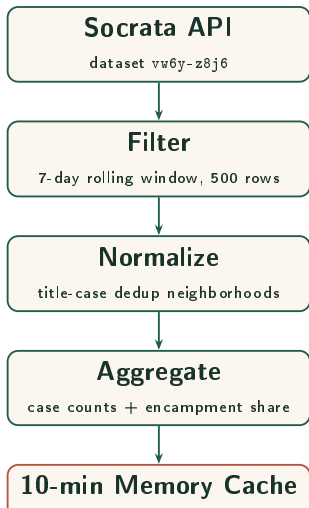
Runs Every 6 Hours

A scheduled job on DigitalOcean pulls the latest listings from partner nonprofits, so the catalog stays fresh without manual updates.

Smart Deduplication

Each import is fingerprinted. If the source page hasn't changed, we skip it. If our parsing rules change, we re-evaluate even unchanged pages.

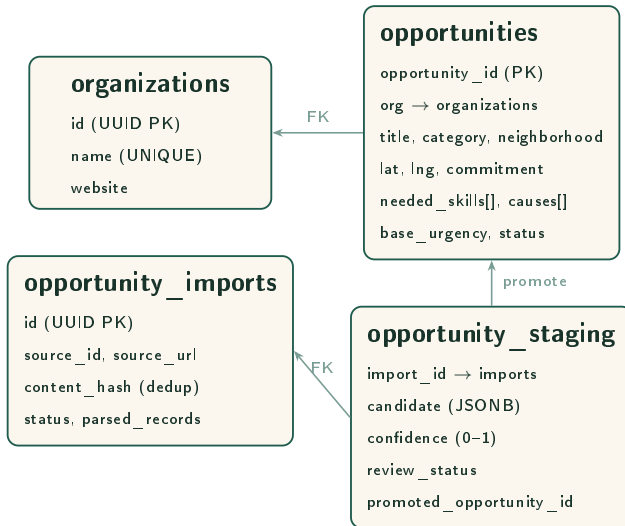
Community Needs: Live SF 311 Data



Data Rules

- Freshness label with `updated_at` timestamp
- Stale data labelled honestly, never faked as live
- Counts as directional context, not crisis claims
- Top 8 neighborhoods by case volume
- Top 3 categories per neighborhood

Data Model



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Deployed on DigitalOcean App Platform

Powered by DigitalOcean AI Platform · Live SF 311 Open Data · PostgreSQL